

Tree Story (Due START OF CLASS Dec. 10)

12/10/2025

180 Points Possible

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▼ Details

This is the final assignment for the [Tree Stories Project \(click to read project introduction\)](https://baylor.instructure.com/courses/236311/assignments/2535007).
(<https://baylor.instructure.com/courses/236311/assignments/2535007>)

Introduction:

You will build on your three Tree Reflections to write a Tree Story. It will take **root** in your observations about your chosen tree, **branch** into connections between your tree and your experiences and reading in class, and **leaf out** into a creative response to the tree that takes inspiration from our reading. “Creative” does not mean you need to be artists or creative writers: you have many options for your response—a thoughtful journal, a short reflective essay, a series of photos with narrative, a poem, a painting or piece of music, and more. Your Tree Stories will be converted into webpages and then linked to your tree on [the digital map of "Baylor's Urban Forest" in the Sustainability Map](https://sustainability.web.baylor.edu/sustainability-map/sustainability-map). [↗\(https://sustainability.web.baylor.edu/sustainability-map/sustainability-map\)](https://sustainability.web.baylor.edu/sustainability-map/sustainability-map)

Components

- Your Tree Story will have the components outlined below.
- This linked template shows how the story will fit together on the webpage we will create for your story:
<https://eh.artsandsciences.baylor.edu/tree-stories-template> [↗\(https://eh.artsandsciences.baylor.edu/tree-stories-template\)](https://eh.artsandsciences.baylor.edu/tree-stories-template)
- **SUBMISSION: CLICK HERE TO SUBMIT YOUR TREE STORY TO THE BOX FOLDER THAT WE WILL USE TO COLLECT MATERIALS FOR THIS PROJECT.** (<https://baylor.instructure.com/courses/236311/pages/tree-story-submission-due-by-class-dec-8>)

Title, Byline, Statement, and Welcome (20 points):

- **Title** capturing the main impression you want your reader to take away about your tree
- **Tree Tag #:** Under your title note the tag # for your tree (e.g., # 3142) that is listed after the species name at the top of the pop-up box for the tree on the Baylor Urban Forest layer of the Sustainability map.
- **Byline** (e.g., “by Poplar Oak for Dr. Joshua King’s ENG 2301: British Literature class, Fall 2025”)
- Follow with this statement: “This reflection is part of a series of “Tree Stories” by Baylor students that take **root** in their observations about a tree on campus, **branch** into connections between their tree and their experiences and education, and **leaf out** into a creative response to the tree.”
- **Welcome:** A few sentences noting the main thing you hope your reader will take away from your story.

Roots (200-300 words, 30 points): Building on your first reflection, describe your initial encounter with the tree—its appearance, surroundings, and why you decided to meditate upon it across the semester. Note what resonated with you when you learned about its physical qualities and species. Reflect upon why these qualities of the tree have made an impression on you.

Branches (400-500 words, 50 points): Building upon thoughts and connections formed in your third and second reflections, share with your reader one formative experience/observation you have had while visiting your tree over the semester. Explain how at least one or two readings from the semester have informed your view of this experience/the tree. You should accompany this portion of your story with a related drawing/photo that you created/took during your visits.

Leaves (Length and Medium on Option Chosen, 80 points): Building on ideas from your third reflection and our Dec. 3 workshop, compose a creative response to your tree. You can choose between options below. You can propose other options, or creative combinations of the ones below, and receive approval from me to pursue them. **In every case, your creative response should be preceded by a statement (200-300 words) noting how it is inspired by and applies insights or approaches gained from one reading on our syllabus.**

 Support ?

- **Work of prose (nonfiction or fiction) of 4-5 pages** using 12 pt. double-spaced font and 1" margin. For example, you might write a brief story in which your tree features centrally, a reflective essay about the value of this and other campus trees, or a series of more fully developed journal entries (taking inspiration from a writer on our syllabus like Dorothy Wordsworth, and drawing from your notebooks).
- **Poem(s), at least 30 total lines**, which could be broken into several smaller poems or written as a single poem. Poems should try to apply techniques, insights, or approaches learned from at least one poem on our syllabus.
- **Other Media/Mixed Media** forms that respond to your tree by thoughtfully and creatively drawing inspiration from at least one reading on our syllabus. You could do a painting, visual artwork combining several media, a series of photos interspersed with reflections or tiny poems, a musical composition, a video, a sculpture, or other form of expression. In every case, your introductory statement will need to justify your choice of medium and how it draws upon our readings to respond to your tree. **Remember that your creation will ultimately be displayed on a webpage** (so, if you made a sculpture, you'd have to take a high-quality photo that could convey its size and details digitally).

Formatting and Quotations:

All portions of the story other than the creative response to your tree in the "Leaves" section should follow the guidelines for formatting and quotations below, which you have used in your three previous tree reflections. This includes the 200-300-word statement preceding your creative response.

- Format: 12 pt font Times New Roman, 1" margins, double-spaced.
- Word files preferred.
- Quotations and In-Text Citations: Since you will be engaging readings from our syllabus more carefully in this reflection, you will need to pay attention to how you quote material and use in-text parenthetical citations. See these two pages for tips:
 - **MLA Style: In-Text Citations**
(https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/mla_style/mla_formatting_and_style_guide/mla_in_text_citations_the_basics.html)
 - **MLA Style: Formatting Quotations**
(https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/mla_style/mla_formatting_and_style_guide/mla_formatting_quotations.html)
- Document sources you use at the end in **MLA-style "Works Cited"**
(https://owl.purdue.edu/owl/research_and_citation/mla_style/mla_formatting_and_style_guide/index.html) **list**. This will not count as part of your total word count/page limit. Many of our readings are stored as digital files on Canvas, and in a number of cases full bibliographic information has not been included in the file. In those cases, you can simply list the author's name and the title of the work in your bibliographic entry (for example: Wordsworth, William. "Yew-Trees.")